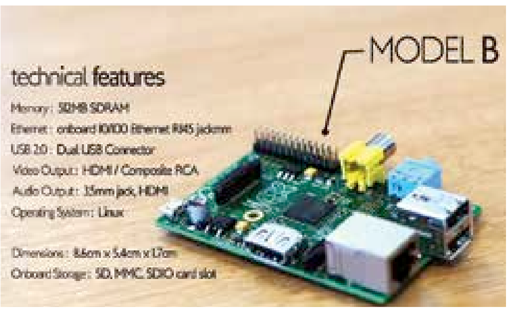
browser and an assortment of programming tools. With all the preparations finished, the six year journey of the Raspberry Pi's development led to the sale of the Model A on 29 February 2012. The Model A which was initially planned to have only 128 MB of RAM was quickly augmented before the sale to provide 256MB of RAM. In certain cases there were over four million pre-order enquiries and over 100,000 confirmed pre-orders for the first run of the boards.

The Raspberry Pi Menu

Now the Raspberry Pi and Pi 2 comes in a variety of models. The most affordable model from the first series is the Model A+, priced at USD 20 with the following specifications: Broadcom 2835 SoC (System on a Chip) which includes the CPU, GPU, DSP, SDRAM and one USB port, a 700 MHz single core ARM processor, a Broadcom VideoCore IV processor clocking at 250 MHz with 24 Gigaflops of OpenGL ES 2.0 operational speeds, 256 MB SDRAM which is shared with the GPU, a 15-pin MIPI CSI connector, a HDMI PAL/NTSC compatible output with a 3.5 mm audio jack and a MicroSD slot. The Model A+ was powered by a 5 V source via the MicroUSB port or the GPIO header and is approximately 2.5–inches on each side weighing in under 23 grams.



Model B remains the most popular version of the Raspberry Pi.

The only non-consumer model that was created in 2014 was the Compute Module which used the same SoC from Broadcom with a 512 MB RAM to be used as a part of embedded systems. These modules are available for purchase in batches of 100 and are priced at USD 30. The Model A, Model B, Model B+ and the new Raspberry Pi 2 had small variations, in departments such as processor power, RAM capacity and Ethernet ports. But the biggest differences were in their prices which still kept the newest and most powerful options - the Model B+ and Pi 2 - affordable at just USD 35. We will take a closer look at the variations in the next chapter.